Azure status history

This page contains Post Incident Reviews (PIRs) of previous service issues, each retained for 5 years. From November 20, 2019, this included PIRs for all issues about which we communicated publicly. From June 1, 2022, this includes PIRs for broad issues as described in our documentation.

Product:

All

Region:

All

Date:

Last week

November 2024

Preliminary Post Incident Review (PIR) – Azure Storage – Unreachable Blob and Data Lake storage accounts in multiple regions

Tracking ID: PSM0-BQ8

This is our Preliminary PIR to share what we know so far. After our internal retrospective is completed (generally within 14 days) we will publish a "Final" PIR with additional details.

What happened?

Between 00:50 UTC and 12:30 UTC on 13 November 2024, a subset of Azure Blob Storage and Azure Data Lake Storage accounts experienced connectivity errors. The issue manifested as loss of access to Blob and Data Lake storage endpoints of the affected storage accounts, and subsequent unavailability of downstream services that depended on these storage accounts. Since many of the impacted storage accounts were used by other Azure services and major software vendor solutions, the customer impact was widespread. Although unavailable to access, the data stored in these storage accounts was not impacted during this incident. Impacted downstream services included:

- **Azure Log Analytics:** Impacted customers using the West Europe, Southeast Asia, and/or Korea Central regions may have experienced delays and/or stale data when viewing Microsoft Graph activity logs.
- **Azure Container Registry:** Impacted customers using the East US region may have experienced intermittent 5XX errors while trying to pull images from the registry.
- **Azure Storage:** Impacted customers may have experienced DNS resolution failures when interacting with impacted storage accounts in Australia East, Canada Central, Canada East, Central US, East US, East US 2, Japan East, South Central US, UAE North, West US, and/or West US 2.
- **Azure Databricks:** Impacted customers may have experienced failures with launching clusters and serverless compute resources in Australia East, Canada Central, Canada East, Central US, East US, East US 2, Japan East, South Central US, UAE North, West US, and/or West US 2.

What went wrong and why?

Azure Traffic Manager manages and routes blob and data lake storage API requests. The incident was caused by an unintentional deletion of Traffic Manager profiles for the impacted storage accounts. These Traffic Manager profiles were originally part of an Azure subscription pool which belonged to the Azure Storage service. This service was bifurcated with one part eventually deprecated. The Traffic Manager profiles needed to be moved out from the common subscription pool, which was missed. As such, the decommissioning process inadvertently deleted the Traffic Manager profiles under the subscription, leading to loss of access to the affected storage accounts. To learn more about Azure Traffic Manager profiles, see: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/traffic-manager/traffic-manager-manage-profiles.

How did we respond?

Our team immediately initiated efforts to restore Traffic Manager profiles of the affected storage accounts. The recovery took an extended period of time since it required careful effort in reconstructing the Traffic Manager profiles. Recovery was carried out in phases, with the majority of affected accounts restored by 06:24 UTC - and the last set of storage accounts recovered and fully operational by 12:30 UTC. Timeline of key events:

- 13 November 2024 @ 00:50 UTC – First customer impact, triggered by the deletion of a Traffic Manager profile.
- 13 November 2024 @ 01:24 UTC – First customer report of errors.
- 13 November 2024 @ 06:24 UTC – Majority of recovery completed.
- 13 November 2024 @ 12:30 UTC – Recovery complete, incident mitigated.

How are we making incidents like this less likely or less impactful?

We are conducting an in-depth analysis of all learnings from the issue and we will provide an update in the Final PIR. These include:

- Audit and improve the process used to clean-up production service artifacts with built-in safety to prevent impact.
- Expand and complete the process of securing platform resources with resource locks as an additional safety check.
- Reduce blast radius with architectural improvements to improve the resiliency against issues related to traffic manager unavailability.
- Accelerate recovery times by refining restore points and optimizing the recovery process for production service artifacts.

How can customers make incidents like this less impactful?

- Consider ensuring that the right people in your organization will be notified about any future service issues – by configuring Azure Service Health alerts. These can trigger emails, SMS, push notifications, webhooks, and more: https://aka.ms/AzPIR/Alerts
- The impact times above represent the full incident duration, so are not specific to any individual customer. Actual impact to service availability varied between customers and resources – for guidance on implementing monitoring to understand granular impact: https://aka.ms/AzPIR/Monitoring

How can we make our incident communications more useful?

You can rate this PIR and provide any feedback using our quick 3-question survey: https://aka.ms/AzPIR/PSM0-BQ8

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